WINDOWS COMMAND-LINE UTILITY / PUBLIC BETA

LRC BULK FINDER

VERSION 2.1.15





Complete User Manual | Windows Command Line

Offline LRCLIB • Multi-provider search • Greek/G2G AI

Created by Dimitris L. • October 2026

Start here | choose the right file

LRC Bulk Finder searches your MP3 folders for timestamped .lrc lyric files. Start with START_HERE.cmd for normal use. Additional launchers are purpose-built and optional. All commands are run from the extracted Windows program folder.

QUICK DECISION

Already have the large LRCLIB .sqlite3 database? Run CONNECT_EXISTING_LRCLIB_DATABASE.cmd once. Then run START_HERE.cmd → option 4 for offline-only scanning of any new folder. No new database download is needed.

File to double-click	Use it for
START_HERE.cmd	Main entry point. Opens 1 / 2 / 3 / 4 menu; normal lyrics search and offline-only scan.
CONNECT_EXISTING_LRCLIB_DATABASE.cmd	Link a previously extracted LRCLIB database without moving or downloading it.
SETUP_LRCLIB_DATABASE.cmd	Optional first-time automatic download/extraction of the official large LRCLIB SQLite snapshot.
SETUP_LRCLIB_DATABASE_FROM_FILE.cmd	Optional import from a .sqlite3 or .sqlite3.gz file already downloaded.
CLEANUP_LRCLIB_DATABASE.cmd	Delete the compressed download or extracted database with explicit confirmation.
SETUP_GREEK_AI.cmd	Optional Greeklish-to-Greek AI toolkit and model setup.
Run_Diagnostics.cmd	Check Python and dependencies, save troubleshooting log.
Run_LRC_Finder.cmd	Lower-level application launcher used by START_HERE.cmd.
Start_LRC_Finder.bat	Compatibility shortcut; delegates to START_HERE.cmd.

Note: GitHub Release ZIP must be extracted before any CMD/BAT launch. Do not double-click scripts inside the ZIP preview. Database dumps and music files are not bundled.

Installation | first five minutes

1. Requirements

- Windows 10/11; Python 3.10 or newer available as py or python.
- Enough disk space for your lyric reports and candidates; offline database installation is an optional and separate large-storage task.
- An MP3 collection with usable artist/title metadata gives the best results. MusicBrainz Picard is not a requirement.

2. Extract, start and choose

1. Download the Windows ZIP from the GitHub Release.
2. Right-click ZIP > Extract All.
3. Open the extracted LRC Bulk Finder folder.
4. Double-click START_HERE.cmd.
5. Choose 1, 2, 3 or 4 from the startup menu.

On first launch, Run_LRC_Finder.cmd detects Python and may offer to install missing Python packages: mutagen, Unidecode and syncedlyrics. An internet connection is needed to install missing packages, even if you later use offline mode 4.

3. Folder selection

After you choose the main action, a Windows folder picker asks for the folder containing your MP3 files. Pick the parent folder if you want subfolders included. If the folder picker is unavailable, paste the full directory path into the console.

Example: D:\Music\International

Example: D:\Music\Greek

First run recommendation

Choose option 4 if you already have the local LRCLIB database, or option 1 to search online sources too. Test 20 songs before selecting A for an entire collection.

Main menu | options 1–4

Choose what you want to do:

1 - SEARCH for synchronized lyrics

2 - PROMOTE .candidate.lrc files to .lrc (no network)

3 - LRCLIB-only catch-up (prior incomplete searches)

4 - OFFLINE LRCLIB ONLY (scan ANY folder; no internet)

Choose [1/2/3/4] (default 1):

Choose	What happens	Internet?
1 SEARCH	Tries configured offline LRCLIB first, then selected online lyrics routes when needed. Supports Greek/G2G.	Yes for other providers and optional MusicBrainz
2 PROMOTE	Only primary .candidate.lrc files are eligible for manual approval. Requires explicit confirmation.	No
3 CATCH-UP	Checks songs already in an LRCLIB catch-up queue; does not scan arbitrary new folders.	Optional online fallback
4 OFFLINE ONLY	Scans any selected MP3 folder against your configured local SQLite snapshot. Does not need prior history/queue.	No network lookups

What pressing Enter does

At the main menu: pressing Enter chooses 1 — SEARCH. In later prompts, defaults vary: [y/N] means Enter selects No, while [Y/n] means Enter selects Yes. The examples in the following pages make each default explicit.

Use the right action

Need to scan a new folder with the large offline LRCLIB database only? Choose 4, not 3. If option 3 says “No LRCLIB catch-up queue yet,” this is normal for a new directory.

Connect an existing offline LRCLIB database

Use CONNECT_EXISTING_LRCLIB_DATABASE.cmd after upgrading to a new program folder when the large database is already extracted. This tool writes a tiny configuration file; it does not move, duplicate or redownload the SQLite database.

1. Double-click CONNECT_EXISTING_LRCLIB_DATABASE.cmd
2. Select your existing .sqlite3 database in the file picker.
3. If the picker does not appear, paste its complete path.
4. Look for SUCCESS: LOCAL LRCLIB DATABASE CONNECTED

Typical path example

```
D:\DataBase\lrclib-db-dump-20261012T090639Z.sqlite3
```

This path is an example; use the location on the current PC. Select the extracted .sqlite3 file, not the compressed .sqlite3.gz file.

How the new version remembers your database

The connector validates the SQLite snapshot and creates LRCLIB_LOCAL_DB.txt beside the program files. Alternatively, copy that small LRCLIB_LOCAL_DB.txt from the previous working program folder. Leave the database itself where it is.

If linking fails

- Confirm the selected file exists and has extension .sqlite3, .sqlite or .db.
- Do not point to a directory, ZIP or partially extracted snapshot.
- Run the connector again; existing configuration remains unchanged if validation fails.

Option 4 | OFFLINE LRCLIB ONLY

This mode reads your configured local SQLite snapshot without contacting LRCLIB online, other lyrics providers or MusicBrainz. It can scan any chosen folder and does not require an LRCLIB catch-up queue.

Exact prompt	What to select
Greeklish / Greek folder? [y/N]:	N / Enter for international; Y for Greek or Greeklish.
Use installed LOCAL G2G AI for Greek names? [y/N]:	Only shown when Greek mode is Y. Y if optional model is installed; otherwise N / Enter.
Include subfolders? [Y/n]:	Enter / Y includes artist/album folders; N only selected directory.
How many eligible songs? [20 for test, A for all]:	Enter searches 20; A searches all eligible MP3 files.
Start offline-only scan? [y/N]:	Type Y to start. Enter / N cancels safely.

What gets saved?

- SAVED: a verified synchronized file is written beside the MP3 as exactly matching .lrc basename.
- REVIEW: uncertain synchronized candidates are written as .candidate.lrc or numbered alternatives; nothing auto-approved.
- NO_MATCH: no safe local match was found in this snapshot; the MP3 is unchanged.
- Skipped: existing .lrc and LIVE tracks are excluded. MP3 audio/ID3 tags are not modified.

Reports created in the selected music folder

LRC_Offline_Only_Report_v2_1_15.csv

LRC_Offline_Only_Review_v2_1_15.csv

Large libraries: 10,000+ MP3s

Option 4 can process large collections without provider throttling. Test 20 songs, review outcomes, then use A. Keep Windows awake, keep the database available and avoid opening database cleanup while a scan is active.

Option 1 | SEARCH: all providers

Option 1 can use the installed local LRCLIB snapshot before attempting online LRCLIB, and continue with selected other providers when no verified result is found. It can use metadata variants for Greeklish music. FAST and FULL control which online lyrics routes are eligible.

Exact prompt	Recommended answer / meaning
Greeklish / Greek folder? [y/N]:	Y for Greek/Greeklish; Enter/N for international.
Use your installed LOCAL G2G AI model? [y/N]:	If Greek mode Y: Y only when model installed; N otherwise.
MusicBrainz extra artist/title metadata for this folder? [Y/n]	N for faster runs with clean tags. Enter/Y to fetch extra metadata spellings.
Search mode: FAST (5 useful providers) or FULL (all 12)? [F/full]:	Enter/F for FAST; type FULL for all 12 routes.
Wait for temporary provider recovery before EACH first attempt? [Y/n]	Enter/Y prioritizes coverage; can be much slower during outages.
Include subfolders? [Y/n]:	Enter/Y scans the selected directory and its subfolders.
Skip identical provider searches completed NO_MATCH in the last 7 days? [Y/n]:	Enter/Y saves time; N deliberately repeats previous completed no-match searches.
How many missing songs? [20 for test, A for all]:	Enter = 20 test files; A = all eligible files.
Optional LRCLIB exact-signature fallback? [y/N]	Enter/N normally; Y adds an optional extra online LRCLIB request.
After the Greek/AI preview, automatically SEARCH lyrics? [Y/n]:	Greek mode only. Enter/Y continues unattended; N preview only.

Source route availability changes over time. HTTP 401/403/429/503 do not indicate an MP3 has no lyrics. Providers can be unavailable despite a valid installation.

Option 2 | candidate review & approval

LRC Bulk Finder intentionally does not auto-approve uncertain timed lyrics. Instead, it writes candidate files beside the corresponding MP3:

```
Example Song.mp3
Example Song.candidate.lrc
Example Song.candidate.2.lrc
```

Approval process

- Run START_HERE.cmd → select 2 → choose the folder.
- Answer Include subfolders? [Y/n] (Enter includes subfolders).
- The program previews eligible primary .candidate.lrc files.
- Listen and inspect the candidate for the correct recording/remix and timestamps before approval.
- At Promote all eligible candidates to approved .lrc? [y/N], type Y only if you have reviewed them. Pressing Enter cancels.
- Only primary .candidate.lrc is considered; numbered alternatives remain untouched.

Important safety limitation

Option 2 checks that candidate files are valid synchronized LRC files and that matching MP3 filenames exist. It does not listen to the recording or guarantee lyric timing correctness. Human review is essential before bulk promotion.

Promotion report

```
LRC_Candidate_Promotion_Report_v2_1_8.csv
```

This historic filename remains in v2.1.15 for backward compatibility. It does not mean the application reverted to v2.1.8.

Option 3 | LRCLIB catch-up

Catch-up is designed for incomplete LRCLIB searches recorded by earlier option 1 runs (such as HTTP 503, 429 or provider cooldown). It does not scan arbitrary new folders. If the selected directory has no queue, use option 4 instead.

Exact prompt	What it means
After OFFLINE misses, contact the online LRCLIB API? [y/N]:	Enter/N: local database only. Y: allow online fallback for missed songs.
Greeklish / Greek filenames for catch-up? [y/N]:	Y for Greek/Greeklish; otherwise Enter/N.
Also try optional LRCLIB exact lookup? [y/N]:	Enter/N is conservative; Y adds an extra online exact query when enabled.
Start LRCLIB-only catch-up now? [y/N]:	Type Y to start; Enter cancels.

How results are handled

- Previously queued songs with a verified local match are saved.
- Unmatched songs stay pending when coverage remains incomplete.
- Existing .lrc sidecars are preserved and not replaced.
- Online 503 safety handling can suspend further LRCLIB requests; it does not force an overloaded server.

For a new folder with 10,000 MP3s

Choose option 4 — OFFLINE LRCLIB ONLY, not option 3. Option 4 starts from the selected MP3 folder; catch-up only works from previously saved queue entries.

Automatic database setup & local import

SETUP_LRCLIB_DATABASE.cmd — official automatic installer

For users without an existing local LRCLIB database. The installer discovers a snapshot from LRCLIB, asks for confirmation, downloads a compressed SQLite dump, extracts and validates it, and saves the local path.

Prompt	Correct choice
Find the newest official LRCLIB snapshot online? [y/N]:	Y to search the catalog; Enter cancels.
Continue with this LARGE download and local installation? [y/N]:	Y only after checking available disk space and internet capacity.
Destination folder selection	Select a drive/folder with ample free space; avoid cloud-synced storage for SQLite.

Storage size example — not a guaranteed requirement

A real official October 2026 snapshot extracted to approximately 243.5 GiB from a compressed archive around 44.6 GiB. New snapshots may be larger. The program does not bundle the database in its GitHub ZIP.

SETUP_LRCLIB_DATABASE_FROM_FILE.cmd — manual fallback

If the user already downloaded an official .sqlite3 or .sqlite3.gz snapshot independently, use this launcher to select or paste the file location, extract if needed, validate SQLite, and store the resulting local path. This is not necessary when linking an already extracted database—use CONNECT_EXISTING instead.

What if the official catalog is unavailable?

An unavailable dump catalog does not stop normal SEARCH. Users can use option 1 without any local database or link a previously extracted snapshot. Automatic installation is optional and depends on LRCLIB infrastructure.

Safe database cleanup | choose carefully

Run CLEANUP_LRCLIB_DATABASE.cmd only when the installer has finished and no offline scan is active. The cleanup utility lists the exact database files it recognizes and requires typed confirmation before deletion.

Choice	Effect	Keep offline?
1	Delete downloaded .sqlite3.gz archive only; reclaim disk space after successful extraction.	Yes
2	Delete extracted .sqlite3 database; retain archive.	No
3	Delete both archive and extracted database.	No
4 / Enter	Cancel without making changes.	Yes

Confirmation behavior

The program demands an exact phrase such as DELETE DOWNLOAD; a simple Y is not enough. It rejects unrelated paths and is intended to delete only recognized auto-installed database files, not music files.

Recommended cleanup

After confirming the SQLite database works, choose 1 to remove only the compressed download. Do not select 2 or 3 if you want to keep using option 4. Files installed/configured manually may not be eligible for this cleanup utility.

Greeklish / Greek AI setup

SETUP_GREEK_AI.cmd — optional

This installer sets up the local Greeklish-to-Greek G2G model from gr-nlp-toolkit. It is useful for Greeklish or inconsistent Greek tags but not required for standard international music. The model and dependencies are installed separately.

Prompt	What to do
Install or verify gr-nlp-toolkit and download/test G2G? [Y/N]	Y if you want the local model and have enough bandwidth/storage; N to cancel.
Greeklish / Greek folder? [y/N] in SEARCH	Y to activate Greek-aware search handling.
Use installed LOCAL G2G AI? [y/N]	Y only if the model was successfully installed; it runs locally.

The installer reports that model downloads plus dependencies can require roughly 1.2 GB. During a lyrics scan, the original artist/title tags are retained; the model suggests additional spellings for searching.

MusicBrainz and Picard

The optional MusicBrainz metadata lookup in mode 1 is independent from MusicBrainz Picard. You do not need Picard installed. Mode 4 deliberately disables remote MusicBrainz lookups to remain offline-only.

Three complete examples

Example A — International collection, completely offline

CONNECT_EXISTING_LRCLIB_DATABASE.cmd > choose existing .sqlite3

START_HERE.cmd > choose 4

Select D:\Music\International

Greek mode N | Include subfolders Y

How many A | Start scan Y

Output: verified .lrc files and two dedicated offline reports. No provider HTTP queries.

Example B — International collection, all providers

START_HERE.cmd > choose 1

Greek mode N | MusicBrainz N

Search mode FULL | Include subfolders Y

Provider recovery Y | Seven-day history Y

How many 20 to test; later A | Exact fallback N

Output: offline LRCLIB (if connected), then applicable online lyrics sources and detailed reports.

Example C — Greek / Greeklish music

SETUP_GREEK_AI.cmd > Y (one-time optional setup)

START_HERE.cmd > choose 4 (offline) or 1 (all sources)

Select your Greek MP3 folder

Greek mode Y | Local G2G AI Y if installed

Subfolders Y | Test 20; then A

Output: original metadata is preserved, Greek alternatives can improve search variants, but all candidates still need strict version/duration verification.

Reports, results & interpretation

File / message	Meaning
*.lrc	Approved timestamped lyrics sidecar for the same-basename MP3.
*.candidate.lrc	Unverified timed candidate for manual review (numbered variants may exist).
LRC_Offline_Only_Report_v2_1_15.csv	Each MP3 processed by option 4; result and reason.
LRC_Offline_Only_Review_v2_1_15.csv	Unverified offline candidates and destination paths.
LRC_HTTP_Diagnostics_v2_1_15.csv	HTTP response and provider-error details from normal online search.
LRC_Source_Statistics_v2_1_15.csv	Summarized provider results from normal search.
LRC_First_Attempt_Coverage_v2_1_15.csv	Whether a provider actually received a first request or why it was skipped.
LRC_LRCLIB_Catchup_Queue_v2_1_15.csv	Incomplete LRCLIB lookups eligible for later catch-up.
NO_MATCH	The search completed but did not yield an acceptable synchronized match.
HTTP 503	Service unavailable/overloaded; not the same as “no lyrics exist”.
HTTP 429	Remote rate limit; respect the provider cooldown.
HTTP 401/403	Provider access is refused; do not treat as a clean no-match.

Some older reports retain historical filenames for compatibility. A source can be temporarily disabled or inaccessible; review the diagnostics rather than assuming every selected provider completed a request.

Safety, reliability & troubleshooting

How safe matching works

- Existing .lrc sidecars are skipped. MP3 audio data and artist/title tags are not overwritten.
- Automatic save requires verified artist/title, compatible recording version/remix and a close duration (up to 3 seconds).
- Uncertain synchronized lyrics remain candidates instead of being installed as approved sidecars.
- Only genuine network timeouts are eligible for exact provider/song retry rounds 2 and 3. HTTP 429/503, NO_MATCH and authorization errors do not trigger timeout retries.
- Offline mode 4 uses no lyrics HTTP requests; after a successful initial setup it can work without internet connectivity.

Common issues

Symptom	Next action
Program does not start	Check Python 3.10+, run Run_Diagnostics.cmd and inspect Startup_Diagnostics.txt.
Offline mode says DB not configured	Run CONNECT_EXISTING_LRCLIB_DATABASE.cmd; select extracted SQLite snapshot.
Catch-up reports no queue	Option 3 is queue-only; choose 4 for any new folder.
Many NO_MATCH results	The snapshot may lack those specific edits/remixes or metadata is insufficient; keep safety checks enabled.
Online sources return 503	LRCLIB may be overloaded; respect recovery/circuit-breaker behavior and use offline mode when possible.
Not enough disk space	Keep the extracted database only if needed; cleanup choice 1 reclaims compressed archive without disabling offline search.
Greek model fails	Mode 4/1 can still run without AI: answer N when asked to use local G2G.

Release history | version by version

This is a public-facing summary of documented feature milestones, not a verbatim Git commit history. Earlier versions are grouped where specific changes were not fully recorded in the release artifacts.

Version	Main change
v2.1.15	New 4 — OFFLINE LRCLIB ONLY for any folder; existing DB connector and standalone offline CSV reports.
v2.1.14	Safe database cleanup CMD, confirmed archive/database deletion choices, installed-size feedback.
v2.1.13	Official database JSON catalog discovery fix with validated snapshot downloads.
v2.1.12	Optional automatic downloader/installer for official LRCLIB SQLite snapshots.
v2.1.11	Local SQLite snapshot searches; online LRCLIB overload safety stop; retained catch-up queue.
v2.1.10	First-attempt provider coverage diagnostics and more conservative temporary recovery handling.
v2.1.9	LRCLIB 503/429 stability work, optional exact lookup and persistent catch-up list.
v2.1.8	1/2/3 menu, .candidate.lrc review sidecars and explicit promotion.
v2.1.7	LRCLIB priority and HTTP 503 handling refinements.
v2.1.6	Detailed provider diagnostics, errors, skips and HTTP status reporting.
v2.1.5	Optional MusicBrainz lookup for international/Greek libraries; LRCLIB project identification.
v2.1.4	Reliability, history and reporting improvements; public beta packaging.
v2.1.3	Stricter artist/title/version/duration verification and review safeguards.
v2.1.2	Public distribution cleanup and general-purpose Windows packaging.
v2.0–v2.1.1	More search routes, Greek word handling and optional local G2G AI.
v1.0–v1.9	Original Windows synchronized-lyrics search, Greeklish support and targeted retries.

Public release | credits & responsible use

Project

LRC Bulk Finder — Windows command-line synchronized lyrics downloader. Created by Dimitris L.
Repository: github.com/DimitrisLai/LRC-Bulk-Finder

Data and network privacy

Option 1 sends artist/title metadata to enabled external lyrics services and optionally MusicBrainz. Option 4 does not contact those services, but installation of missing Python packages or an optional Greek model may require internet access beforehand. No music collection or third-party lyric database is bundled in the project archive.

Sources and redistribution

The project uses third-party Python libraries and external provider services. Their own licenses, usage rules and content rights remain applicable. A public SQLite dump can be downloaded separately from LRCLIB, but this project does not redistribute its contents.

Support and issue reports

For a reproducible issue, include the application version, selected menu option, Windows/Python versions, an example of the console message and redacted diagnostics. Do not upload copyrighted lyric collections, private file paths or personal tokens to a public GitHub issue.

Public Beta notice

This release has been tested offline with fixtures and simulations. Provider interfaces, rate limits, full-size SQLite snapshots, and different Windows configurations can change. The program cannot guarantee synchronized lyrics for every recording.